

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Of Souls And Moms-In-Law

These have to be the funniest “we-found-this-on-eBay” so far. A Chinese man tried to sell his soul on Taobao, China’s top online auction site. He attracted bids from some 58 potential buyers before the posting was brought down, reports China Daily. The reason? According to a spokesman, they wanted more proof that the seller could provide the goods.

Then there was this bloke called Steve Owen who

published a photo of his 50-year-old mother-in-law under “Collectables And Weird Stuff,” listing her as “used.” He invited bids starting at just £1 (Rs 80). Steve was “deadly serious”: “She comes to the house every day trying to change me and make me tidy. I just hope someone will take her off my hands. She’s single and not bad looking.” Now you know what to do when your mom-in-law gets on your nerves—check ebay.in’s policies on this, though!

Graves Come To Life!

ADutch inventor has developed a digital tombstone with an LCD display. It has an infrared sensor that activates the display when someone stands in front of the grave. Then, the screen lights up with messages from the deceased, along with videos and pictures. Of course, you can make the thing do whatever you want—it’s more of an idea than an invention.

Henk Rozema came up with the idea after he made a DVD of his own life to show at his birthday party. A lot of his friends asked for copies of the DVD, and Rozema had a eureka moment. He thought he had died and gone to heaven, and thought up the digital tombstone. “I’m an engineer and I

thought that must be possible,” he is reported to have said. “We are not the Flintstones. This is the digital age!”

Indeed. We think it’s a cool idea. How boring are gravestones that do nothing but indicate dates and names?

There’s a little hitch with the whole concept, though. The deceased doesn’t know what’s being showcased on his grave, so suppose a vengeful family member put up photos of him with pie on his face—or something along those lines? How about some nice embarrassing videos? Sort of kills the gravity of the situation, if you’ll pardon the horrible pun. So do the dead have rights? Calling all American lawyers...

Two Million Hits And A Threesome

You know we’re well and truly in an online world when your girlfriend links sex to page hits. A certain girl called Allison told her boyfriend Jim that she’d agree to a ménage-à-trois if he managed two million page hits on his site. She’d bitten off more than she could chew, as it turned out.

You know we’re well and truly in a mad, mad world full of boredom and decadence when that Web site actually gets two million hits and more—just so some random guy can have sex with two women at once—courtesy word-of-mouth, forwards, and mentions like this one here! Well done, mate, and good luck!



Head to helpwinmybet.com for the details... last we checked, a forum had been added. In fact, the site seems to be a hub of activity, but an angel warned us not to click any of the links on the site.

Royal Mail

HRM Queen Elizabeth II was already online in 1976, when the Internet was still ARPAnet, we learn from her official Web site (www.royal.gov.uk). You can find there a list of 80 facts about the Queen released by Buckingham Palace to mark her 80th birthday on April 21, which, interestingly, is officially celebrated in May or June, depending on country!

Fact #53 simply states, “The Queen sent her first email in 1976 from an Army base.” Not much detail there—what the mail was about, or why it needed to be sent.

Also in the list of 80 facts is this one: “The Queen is a



keen photographer and enjoys taking photographs of her family.” No mention here about whether HRM has gone digital...!

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